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BAGONG PILIPINAS

CC 101 – Introduction to Computing

Laboratory Worksheet No. 1 | Week 3: Computer Components I – Hardware (CO2)

"Know Your Machine": Exploring the Computer Unit You Are Using

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Computer Unit Used (Desktop/Laptop, brand): **DESKTOP** **Date:** September 16,2026

I. Objectives

At the end of this activity, you should be able to:

- Identify the major hardware components of the computer unit you are using and describe the function of each.
- Use built-in Windows 11 tools to inspect and record your computer's technical specifications.
- Distinguish between input, output, processing, and storage devices on an actual working computer.
- Document your exploration accurately and reflect on what you learned.

II. Materials Needed

- A computer unit running Windows 11 (school laboratory PC or personal laptop/desktop)
- This worksheet (printed copy, or the digital file to fill out and submit)
- Optional: smartphone camera, to photograph the physical unit and ports for your own reference

III. Background

Every computer, whether a desktop tower or a laptop, is built from hardware components that fall into four general categories: input devices (send data into the computer, e.g., keyboard, mouse), output devices (present processed data to the user, e.g., monitor, speakers), the processing/storage unit (CPU, RAM, and drives that compute and hold data), and ports/peripherals (connectors that link external devices to the system unit). Windows 11 also provides several built-in tools — Settings, System Information, Device Manager, and Task Manager — that let you inspect these components without opening the case. This activity uses both direct observation and these software tools.

IV. Procedure

Part A – Physical Inspection (5–10 minutes)

1. Examine the computer unit in front of you. If it is a desktop, look at the system unit (tower/case); if it is a laptop, examine the whole chassis.
2. List all the input devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., keyboard, mouse, touchpad, webcam, microphone).
3. List all the output devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., monitor/screen, speakers, headphone jack).
4. Locate the available ports on the unit (USB-A, USB-C, HDMI, audio jack, Ethernet/LAN, power, etc.) and note what each one is typically used to connect.

Part B – System Identification (Settings)

5. Click Start → Settings → System → About.

6. Record the Device name, Processor, Installed RAM, Device ID, and System type shown under Device specifications.
7. Scroll down to Windows specifications and record the Edition, Version, and OS build.

Part C – Detailed Hardware Check (System Information)

8. Press the Windows key, type System Information, and open it (this runs the msinfo32 tool).
9. On the System Summary page, record the System Manufacturer, System Model, BIOS Version/Date, and Total Physical Memory.

Part D – Device Manager Exploration

10. Right-click the Start button and choose Device Manager.
11. Expand at least six (6) categories — for example: Display adapters, Network adapters, Sound/video/game controllers, Disk drives, Keyboards, Mice and other pointing devices, and Universal Serial Bus controllers.
12. For each category you expand, write down the specific device name Windows lists (this is the exact model of that component in your unit).

Part E – Performance and Storage Check (Task Manager)

13. Open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc) and click the Performance tab.
14. Record the CPU name, base speed, and number of cores; the total Memory (RAM) and its speed; and the Disk type (HDD or SSD) and capacity.

Part F – Software Snapshot (Optional / Bonus)

15. Go to Settings → Apps → Installed apps. List five (5) installed applications and classify each as System Software or Application Software.

V. Data and Findings

Table 1. System Identification Summary (Parts B & C)

Item	Your Findings
Device name	DESKTOP-4MKSC1R
Processor	12th Gen Intel(R) Core (TM) i5-12400 2.50 GHz
Installed RAM	16.0 GB (15.8 GB usable)
Device ID	635A5817-6B5D-4DD7-BDB1-OBD91DB6852E
System type (32-bit / 64-bit)	64-bit operating system, x64-based professor
Windows edition	Windows 10 Pro
Windows version	22H2
OS build	19045.5011
System manufacturer	Micro-Star International Co., Ltd.

Item	Your Findings
System model	MS-7D48
BIOS version / date	American Megatrends International, LLC, A.EO, 1/11/2024
Total physical memory	15.8 GB

Table 2. Physical Components Observed (Part A)

Component Observed	Type (Input/Output/Storage/Processing/Port)	Description / Observation
Keyboard	Input	Built-in, used to type letters and numbers
Touchpad	Input	Built-in, controls the cursor like a mouse
Screen/Display	Output	Shows what i'm doing on the computer
Speakers	Output	Built-in, plays sound and audio
Webcam	Input	At top of screen, takes photos and videos
USB port	Port	For flash drive, mouse, and other devices
HDMI port	Port	Connects to TV or projector
Power port	Port	Where the charger plugs in
Microphone	Input	Built-in, picks up my voice

Table 3. Device Manager Findings (Part D)

Device Manager Category	Specific Device Name Listed
Display adapters	Intel(R) UHD Graphics 730

Device Manager Category	Specific Device Name Listed
Network adapters	Pealtek PCIe GbE Family Controller VirtualBox Host-Only Ethernet Adapter WAN Mainport (IKEv2) WAN Mainport (IP) WAN Mainport (IPv6) WAN Mainport (L2TP) WAN Mainport (Network Monitor) WAN Mainport (PPPOE) WAN Mainport (PPTP) WAN Mainport (SSTP)
Sound, video and game controllers	HD Audio Driver for Display Audio HD Audio Driver for Display Audio High Definition Audio Device
Disk drives	TEAM T253256GB
Keyboards	HID Keyboard Device
Mice and other pointing devices	HID- compliant mouse
Universal Serial Bus controllers	Generic USB Hub Intel(R) USB 3?20 eXtensible Host Controller – 1.20 (Microsoft) USB Composite Device USB Root Hub (USB 3.0)

Table 4. Software Snapshot (Part F, Optional / Bonus)

Installed Application	Classification (System / Application Software)
Goggle Chrome	Application Software
Microsoft Word	Application Software
Windows Defender	System Software
Settings	System Software

Installed Application	Classification (System / Application Software)
Canva	Application Software

VI. Realization (Reflection)

In two to four sentences each, answer the following in your own words.

1. What did you discover about your own computer unit that you did not know before doing this activity?

I had no idea what my processor was called or exactly how much memory my computer really has. I also never really paid attention to all the ports and what each one is actually for. It was interesting to see all the parts listed clearly inside the system settings.

2. Which hardware component do you think matters most to how your computer performs, and why?

I think the processor matters most because its like the brain it does all the thinking and calculations. A faster processor means opening apps and running programs will be quicker without a good processor, even with enough storage, the computer would feel slow.

3. How might knowing your computer's hardware and software specifications help you as a future IT/CS professional?

It will help me know what my computer can really do and what programs it can handle well. I can also fix problems faster when I understand the parts inside. This knowledge will make me better at choosing and using the right tools for my future work.

4. What difficulties, if any, did you encounter while completing this activity, and how did you resolve them?

At first I could not find some of the settings and I felt a little confused. I solved it by reading the steps slowly and carefully, then following them one by one. I also double-checked the numbers to make sure I wrote them down correctly.

VII. Scoring Guide

Criteria	Description	Points
Completeness	All tables (1–4) and required fields are filled out.	30
Accuracy	Recorded specifications and device names match what the tools actually show.	30
Realization / Reflection	Answers are thoughtful, specific to the student's own unit, and well written.	30

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Criteria	Description	Points
Neatness & Timeliness	Worksheet is legible/well-formatted and submitted on time.	10
Total		**100**

Checked by: **Score:** / 100

Instructor's Signature over Printed Name / Date